

35.6 KEY LANGUAGE MAKING EXCUSES

Sometimes you need to say why you can't do something. To be polite, use an expression like "Sorry, I can't" before saying what your other plans are.



Would you like to go to the movies tonight?

Sorry, I can't. I'm working late.

To be polite, apologize first.

Use the present continuous to say what you are doing instead.



35.7 FURTHER EXAMPLES MAKING EXCUSES

I'd like to, but I'm going to the dentist.



That would be fun, but I'm visiting family.



I'd love to, but I'm meeting friends.



That sounds nice, but I'm playing baseball.



35.8 REWRITE THE SENTENCES, PUTTING THE WORDS IN THE CORRECT ORDER

tonight. fun, but theater That the I'm going to would be

That would be fun, but I'm going to the theater tonight.

1 my parents I'm Sorry, I can't. visiting this evening.

2 this like to, but weekend. I'd France going to I'm

3 sounds but I'm going That on Tuesday. nice, swimming

4 love to, I'm looking after I'd my nephew tomorrow. but

